

DISTICTIS

trumpet-shaped flowers. Frost tender. Well-drained soil is suitable with full light. Water freely in summer, less at other times. Support for stems is necessary. Thin out congested growth in spring. Propagate by softwood cuttings in early summer or by semiripe cuttings in late summer. **D. buccinatoria**, syn. *Phaedranthus buccinatorius* (Mexican blood flower), illus. p.461.

DISTYLIUM

HAMAMELIDACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and trees, grown for their foliage and flowers. Prefers a sheltered, partially shaded position and moist, peaty soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer. **D. racemosum**. Evergreen, arching shrub. H 6ft (2m), S 10ft (3m). Leaves are oblong, leathery, glossy and dark green. Bears small flowers, with red calyces and purple anthers, in late spring–early summer. Z11

DOCYNIA

ROSACEAE

Genus of evergreen, semievergreen or deciduous trees and shrubs, grown for their flowers and foliage. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Other than shaping while young, pruning is not necessary. Propagate by seed in spring or fall, by budding in summer, or by grafting in winter. Caterpillars may be troublesome. **D. delavayi**. Evergreen or semievergreen, spreading tree. H and S 25ft (8m) or more. Ovate to lance-shaped leaves are white-felted beneath. In spring, has fragrant white flowers, pink in bud; ovoid, downy, yellow fruits follow in fall. Z8–10

DODECATHEON

Shooting stars

PRIMULACEAE

Genus of spring- and summer-flowering perennials, grown for their flowers, which have reflexed petals and prominent stamens. Once fertilized, flowers turn skyward—hence their common name. Dormant after flowering. Prefers sun or partial shade and moist, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in fall or by division in winter. **D. dentatum**. Clump-forming perennial. H 3in (7cm), S 10in (25cm). Leaves are long, ovate and toothed. Bears white flowers with prominent, dark stamens and reflexed petals, in spring. Prefers partial shade. Z4–8 **D. hendersonii**, syn. *D. latifolium*, illus. p.333. **D. latifolium**. See *D. hendersonii*. **D. meadia**. Clump-forming perennial. H 8in (20cm), S 6in (15cm). Leaves are ovate and pale green. In spring, bears pale pink flowers, with reflexed petals, above foliage. Prefers a partially shaded site. Z4–8. **f. album** illus. p.333. **D. pauciflorum** of gardens. See *D. pulchellum*. **D. pulchellum**, syn. *D. pauciflorum* of gardens. Clump-forming perennial. H 6in (15cm), S 4in (10cm). Similar to *D. meadia*, but flowers are usually deep cerise. Z4–7. **subsp. pulchellum ‘Red Wings’** illus. p.333.

DODONAEA

SAPINDACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and small trees, grown mainly for their foliage and overall appearance. Prefers full sun and well-drained soil. Water potted plants freely when in full growth, less at other times. Cut back in late summer and in spring if needed, to maintain a balanced shape. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in late summer. **D. viscosa ‘Purpurea’** illus. p.457.

Dolichos lablab. See *Lablab purpureus*. **Dolichos purpureus**. See *Lablab purpureus*.

DOMBEYA

MALVACEAE

Genus of evergreen or deciduous shrubs and trees, grown for their flowers. Frost tender. Needs full sun or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Water containerized plants freely when in full growth, less when temperatures fall. Cut back after flowering. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. Whitefly and red spider mite may be a nuisance. **D. burgessiae**, syn. *D. mastersii*. Evergreen shrub. H 6–12ft (2–4m), S 5–10ft (1.5–3m). Has rounded, 3-lobed, downy leaves and dense clusters of fragrant, white flowers, with pink to red veins, in fall–winter. Z12–15 (min. 50°F/10°C) **D. x cayeuxii** (Pink snowball) illus. p.450. **D. mastersii**. See *D. burgessiae*.

Dondia. See *Hacquetia*.

DORONICUM

Leopard’s bane

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of perennials, grown for their daisylike flowers, which are good for cutting. Most prefer full sun or part shade and moist, well-drained soil. Propagate by division in fall. **D. austriacum**. Clump-forming perennial. H 18in (45cm), S 1ft (30cm). Bears daisylike, pure yellow flower heads on slender stems in spring, above heart-shaped, wavy-edged, bright green, hairy leaves. Z5–8 **D. columnae**, syn. *D. cordatum*. Clump-forming, rhizomatous perennial. H 5–24in (12–60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Bears clustered, ovate-rounded to heart-shaped, toothed, hairy or hairless, scalloped leaves. Slender stems bear solitary yellow flower heads in midspring to early summer. Z4–9 **D. ‘Miss Mason’** illus. p.227. **D. cordatum**. See *D. columnae*. **D. x excelsum ‘Harpur Crewe’**, syn. *D. plantagineum* ‘Excelsum’. Elegant, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Large, daisylike, buttercup-yellow flower heads are borne, 3 or 4 to a stem, in spring. Leaves are heart-shaped and bright green. Good for dry shade. Z4–8 **D. ‘Frühlingspracht’**, syn. *D. orientale* ‘Frühlingspracht’, *D. orientale* ‘Spring Beauty’. Clump-forming perennial. H 18in (45cm), S 1ft (30cm). Produces daisylike, double, bright yellow flower heads in

spring. Bears heart-shaped, bright green leaves. Z5–8 **D. orientale ‘Frühlingspracht’**. See *D. ‘Frühlingspracht’*. **‘Magnificum’** illus. p.263. **‘Spring Beauty’** see *D. ‘Frühlingspracht’*. **D. plantagineum ‘Excelsum’**. See *D. x excelsum* ‘Harpur Crewe’.

Dorotheanthus. See *Cleretum*.

DORYANTHES

DORYANTHACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of rosette-forming perennial succulents, grown for their flowers. Frost tender. Requires a sunny position and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Propagate by mature bulbils, by seed in spring, or by suckers after flowering. **D. palmeri** illus. p.470.

Dorycnium hirsutum. See *Lotus hirsutus*. **Douglasia vitaliana**. See *Vitaliana primuliflora*. **Doxantha**. See *Macfadyena* except for: *D. capreolata* for which see *Bignonia capreolata*.

DRABA

BRASSICACEAE/CRUCIFERAE

Genus of spring-flowering annuals and evergreen or semievergreen, cushion- or mat-forming perennials. Some species form soft, green cushions that in winter turn brown except at the tips, appearing dead. Suitable for alpine houses. Needs sun and gritty, well-drained soil. Dislikes winter wet. Propagate by softwood cuttings of the rosettes in late spring or by seed in fall. **D. aizoides** (Yellow whitlow grass). Semievergreen, mat-forming perennial. H 1in (25cm), S 6in (15cm). Has lance-shaped, stiff-bristled leaves in rosettes and, in spring, 4-petaled, bright yellow flowers. Suits a scree. Z4–6 **D. bryoides**. See *D. rigida* var. *bryoides*. **D. hispanica**. Semievergreen, cushion-forming perennial. H 2in (5cm), S 4in (10cm). Pale green leaves are ovate and soft. Clusters of flat, 4-petaled, pale yellow flowers are borne in spring. Z4–6 **D. longisiliqua** illus. p.357. **D. mollissima** illus. p.358. **D. polytricha**. Semievergreen, cushion-forming perennial. H 2½in (6cm), S 6in (15cm). Forms rosettes of tiny round leaves. Bears flat, 4-petaled, golden-yellow flowers in spring. Difficult to grow. Keep stones under cushion at all times. Remove dead rosettes at once. Z4–6 **D. rigida** illus. p.357. **var. bryoides** (syn. *D. bryoides*) is an evergreen, hummock-forming perennial. H 1½in (4cm), S 2½in (6cm). Has tiny, round, dark green leaves. Produces small clusters of almost stemless, 4-petaled, bright yellow flowers that cover hummocks in spring. Z4–6

DRACAENA

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of evergreen trees and shrubs, grown for their foliage. Frost tender. Needs full sun or partial shade and well-drained soil. Water potted plants moderately, much less in low temperatures. Renew leggy

plants by cutting back close to soil level in spring. Propagate by seed or air-layering in spring, or by tip or stem cuttings in summer. Mealy bug may be a nuisance. **D. australis**. See *Cordyline australis*. **D. deremensis**. See *D. fragrans* Deremensis Group. **‘Souvenir de Schrijver’** see *D. fragrans* Deremensis Group ‘Souvenir d’August de Schrijver’. **D. draco** illus. p.451. **D. fragrans** (Corn plant). **Deremensis Group**, syn. *D. deremensis*, is a slow-growing sparsely branched shrub. H 6ft (2m) or more, S 3ft (1m) or more. Has lance-shaped, erect to arching, glossy, deep green leaves, to 18in (45cm) long. Mature plants may bear large panicles of small, red-and-white flowers in summer. Z14–15. **‘Lemon Lime’**, H 3–5ft (1–1.5m), S 20in–3ft (50cm–1m), has greenish-white flowers, occasionally followed by red or orange fruit. Leaves have longitudinal bands of greenish-yellow, white and dark green. **‘Souvenir d’August de Schrijver’** (syn. *D. deremensis* ‘Souvenir de Schrijver’) illus. p.454. **D. indivisa**. See *Cordyline indivisa*. **D. marginata** (Madagascar dragon tree). Slow-growing, erect shrub or tree. H 10ft (3m) or more, S 3–6ft (1–2m) or more. Leaves are narrowly strap-shaped and rich green with red margins. Flowers are rarely produced. Z11–12. **‘Tricolor’** illus. p.452. (min. 55°F/13°C)

DRACOCEPHALUM

Dragon’s head

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of annuals, perennials and dwarf evergreen shrubs, suitable for borders and rock gardens. Prefers sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or division in spring or fall, or by basal cuttings of young growth in spring. **D. ruyschiana**. Erect perennial. H 18–24in (45–60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Freely bears whorled spikes of 2-lipped, violet-blue flowers from early to midsummer. Mid-green leaves are linear to lance-shaped. Z3–7 **D. sibiricum**. See *Nepeta sibirica*.

DRACUNCULUS

ARACEAE

Genus of tuberous perennials, grown for their distinctive, but foul-smelling, spathes. Where marginally hardy, protect dormant tubers with heavy mulch. Needs sun and well-drained soil that dries out in summer. Propagate by offsets in late summer or seed in fall. **D. vulgaris**, syn. *Arum dracunculus* (Dragon’s arum), illus. p.386.

DREGEA

APOCYNACEAE/ASCLEPIADACEAE

Genus of evergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climbers, grown for their flowers. Grow in sun and in any well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring or by stem cuttings in summer or fall. **D. corrugata**. See *D. sinensis*. **D. sinensis**, syn. *D. corrugata*, *Wattakaka sinensis*, illus. p.197.